

Yohta Kitagawa: Creative Technologist

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• RESEARCH INTEREST

My vision is Mediating Animacy: designing for the sense that another being might be alive. Entanglements of people, organisms, materials, and environments are already acting and calling for response. Noticing them can lead to fruitful and animate interactions, and I believe technical systems that objectify humans and non-humans can be seen and questioned through this practice. For my doctoral studies, I plan to pursue this vision through material-led tangible interfaces and performances. My thinking comes from anthropology, philosophies of listening and care, choreography, media theory, embodied cognition, and more-than-human and entanglement thinking in design and art.

• EDUCATION

Keio University, Faculty of Environment and Information Studies Apr 2023 – Mar 2027
B.A. in Environment and Information Studies (expected). Research: Nakanishi Lab (HCI/HRI), x-Music Lab (Sound Art), Suwa Lab (Embodied Cognition), Shimizu Lab (Anthropology).
Brown University / Rhode Island School of Design Aug 2025 – May 2026
Exchange student, cross-registered at RISD throughout. Independent Research: Professor Ian Gonsher (Design Engineering), Professor Paula Gaetano Adi (Media Art).

• ACCEPTED PUBLICATIONS

Kitagawa, Y., Xu, Z. [Tele-Bio: Leaving and Receiving Physiological Traces Through a Rotary Telephone](#). ACM UIST 2026 Student Innovation Contest, Adjunct Proceedings. To be presented Nov 2–5, 2026.
Kitagawa, Y. [Listening with a Mealworm Beetle: The Contact Membrane and the Politics of Umwelt-centric Design](#). SIGGRAPH Asia 2026 Art Papers. To be presented orally, Dec 1–4, 2026.

• Under review

Hirose, S., Kitagawa, Y. [Knot-music: Spatial Mixing by Untangling Wired Earphones](#). SIGGRAPH Asia 2026 Posters.
Kitagawa, Y. [Motioning: Selecting Movement–Sound Mappings Using Learning Progress](#). NeurIPS 2026 Creative AI Track.

• SELECTED PERFORMANCES / EXHIBITIONS

“Spoken Words” with Nathan Petree: [Cube Fest 2026](#), Virginia Tech (International) Aug 21–23, 2026
“Motioning”: [Sound End](#), Keio University Jul 14–17, 2026
“NoiseLoom”, “Dancing with Robots”: [BLIP](#), Brown University May 13, 2026
“Contact Membrane”: [Sited Sound final concert](#), RISD Feb 5, 2026

• SELECTED WORK

[Contact Membrane](#) 2026
An interface for interspecies listening. A human and a mealworm beetle share a tensioned paper surface; contact microphones and an IMU magnify the insect's micro-movements into spatialized sound based on its Umwelt.
[NoiseLoom](#) 2026
Networked noise improvisation. Participants draw spectra on a shared screen; the drawings become sound in real time, and improvisation emerges from responding to one another.
[Knot-music](#), with Shinnosuke Hirose 2026
Spatial mixing by untangling wired earphones. The physical constraints and accidents of a knot are reframed as an interface.
[Dancing with Robots](#) In progress
WIP project where I dance with robots that do not necessarily care about me.

• TECHNICAL SKILLS

Sound: Max/MSP, Ableton Live, Spatial Audio
Physical: Physical Computing, Digital Fabrication, Rhino, ROS2
Software: Unity, AI (ML/RL/NLP), p5.js, Web, Computer Graphics, Robotics